Division of Philosophy, Humanities and Library Sciences
Philosophy Department
https://www.hccs.edu/programs/areas-of-study/liberal-arts-humanities--education/philosophy/

Phil 1301: Introduction to Philosophy | Lecture | #11724

Summer 2020 | 5 Weeks (Jun 8 – July 12)
HCC Online | Access Anytime
3 Credit Hours | 48 hours per semester

Instructor Contact Information

Instructor: Normand Theriault
HCC Email: normand.theriault@hccs.edu
Office Hours: 12pm-5pm M-F (via Cisco Webex)
Office Phone: 214-736-7418
Office Location: Online Only

Instructor's Preferred Method of Contact

E-mail is my preferred method of contact. I will respond to emails within 24 hours (7 days a week). I can usually respond immediately during regular working hours, but sometimes it will be a few hours or even overnight before I can return your message. Responding to students is a priority for me, so don't hesitate to send me your concerns or questions at any time.

Course Goals

My focus in this course is on reading, analyzing, and discussing original works by key figures in the history of philosophy. You will become a sharper thinker as a result of your studies in this course. Your writing will become more precise and your ideas clearer. You will gain a basic knowledge of philosophy and be able to apply that knowledge to other areas of life. And you will, despite the difficulty of the texts, enjoy arguing with your professor and fellow students about philosophy!

Prerequisites and/or Co-Requisites

ENGL 1301

Canvas Learning Management System

This section of PHIL 1301 will use Canvas (https://eagleonline.hccs.edu) for assignments, exams, and activities. I expect you to login every day to check the Announcements. Important information is posted throughout the semester. This course uses a number of Canvas' built-in features, including scoring rubrics for written assignments and Turnitin to check for plagiarism. If you have any questions about how to get the most out of your Canvas experience, don't hesitate to ask!

HCCS Open Lab locations may be used to access the Internet and Canvas. **USE FIREFOX OR CHROME (OR SAFARI FOR MAC) AS THE INTERNET BROWSER**.

HCC Online Information and Policies

Here is the link to information about HCC Online classes including the required Online Orientation for all fully online classes: http://www.hccs.edu/online/

Scoring Rubrics, Sample Assignments, etc.

Look in Canvas for the scoring rubrics for assignments, samples of class assignments, and other information to assist you in the course. https://eagleonline.hccs.edu/login/ldap

Instructional Materials

Textbook Information

All texts will be provided free-of-charge (ISBNs provided in case students wish to purchase print copies). The texts we will read this semester are as follows:

Plato, *Euthyphro*, *Apology*, and *Crito* ISBN: 978-0-87220-633-5
Rene Descartes, *Meditations*, ISBN: 978-0-87220-420-1
David Hume, *Enquiry Concerning Human Understanding*, ISBN: 978-0-87220-229-0
G.W.F. Hegel, *The Philosophy of History*, ISBN: 978-0-87220-056-2
Karl Marx & Friedrich Engels, *The Communist Manifesto*, ISBN: 978-0-14044-757-6
Jean-Paul Sartre, *Existentialism Is a Humanism*, ISBN: 978-0-80650-902-0

Other Instructional Resources

This textbook is not required, but could prove useful when writing your term paper (unfortunately there is no free version of this text, though there is an etextbook available):

Anthony Weston, *A Rulebook for Arguments: Fourth Edition*, ISBN: 978-0-87220-954-1

Tutoring

HCC provides free, confidential, and convenient academic support, including writing critiques, to HCC students in an online environment and on campus. Tutoring is provided by HCC personnel in order to ensure that it is contextual and appropriate. Visit the HCC Tutoring Services website for services provided.

Libraries

The HCC Library System consists of 9 libraries and 6 Electronic Resource Centers (ERCs) that are inviting places to study and collaborate on projects. Librarians are available both at the libraries and online to show you how to locate and use the resources you need. The libraries maintain a large selection of electronic resources as well as collections of books, magazines, newspapers, and audiovisual materials. The portal to all libraries' resources and services is the HCCS library web page at http://library.hccs.edu.

Supplementary Instruction

Supplemental Instruction is an academic enrichment and support program that uses peer-assisted study sessions to improve student retention and success in historically difficult courses. Peer Support is provided by students who have already succeeded in completion of the specified course, and who earned a grade of A or B. Find details at http://www.hccs.edu/resources-for/current-students/supplemental-instruction/.

Course Overview

This course is a study of the major issues in philosophy and/or the work of major philosophical figures in philosophy. Topics in philosophy may include theories of reality, theories of knowledge, theories of value, and their practical applications (Texas ACGM). It provides a theoretically diverse introduction to the study of ideas, including arguments and investigations about abstract and real phenomena, particularly in the areas of knowledge, ethics, and religion (HCC Course Catalogue). This course stresses the HCC Core Objectives of Critical Thinking, Communication Skills, Personal Responsibility, and Social Responsibility

Core Curriculum Objectives (CCOs)

This course satisfies the Philosophy, Language, and Culture component area or the Component Area Option in the HCC Core Curriculum. If you are not sure that you need this course to graduate, please consult with your advisor.

Program Student Learning Outcomes (PSLOs)

1. Demonstrate an understanding of arguments, problems, and terminology in philosophy.
2. Analyze and critique philosophical texts in ways that demonstrate an awareness of argument structure and the evaluation of philosophical claims.
3. Present logically persuasive arguments orally and in writing that are relevant to philosophical issues covered in course material.
4. Evaluate personal and social responsibilities of living in a diverse world in terms of the philosophical issues raised in course material.

Course Student Learning Outcomes (CSLOs)

1. Read, analyze, and critique philosophical texts.
2. Demonstrate knowledge of key concepts, major arguments, problems, and terminology in philosophy.
3. Present logically persuasive arguments both orally and in writing.
4. Demonstrate critical thinking skills in evaluation and application of philosophical concepts to various aspects of life.
5. Evaluate the personal and social responsibilities of living in a diverse world.

Learning Objectives

1.1 Read canonical texts in the philosophical tradition.

1.2 Analyze, discuss, and critique philosophical texts in class, including through student presentations.

1.3 Analyze and critique philosophical texts in written work, including papers and tests.

2.1 Learn basic philosophical vocabulary, major arguments, and positions in central areas of philosophy.

2.2 Define key concepts in your own words and provide definitions in regular quizzes.

2.3 Demonstrate understanding of key arguments and claims made by philosophers studied in the course through short answer questions and papers.

3 Present logically persuasive arguments in presentations, papers, and tests.

4.1 Engage in critical thinking through classroom discussion and presentations.

4.2 Demonstrate critical thinking skills in written work.

5.1 Consider the impacts of philosophical ideas on personal and social responsibility.

5.2 Apply philosophical concepts discussed in the course to personal and contemporary issues, demonstrating a concern for social and personal responsibility.

Student Success

Expect to spend many hours per week studying the course content. Additional time will be required for written assignments. The assignments provided will help you use your study hours wisely. Successful completion of this course requires a combination of the following:

- Reading the textbook
- Attending class in person and/or online
- Completing assignments
- Participating in class activities

There is no short cut for success in this course; it requires reading (and probably re-reading) and studying the material using the course objectives as a guide.

Instructor and Student Responsibilities

As your Instructor, it is my responsibility to**:**

- Provide the grading scale and detailed grading formula explaining how student grades are to be derived
- Facilitate an effective learning environment through learner-centered instructional techniques
- Provide a description of any special projects or assignments
- Inform students of policies such as attendance, withdrawal, tardiness, and making up assignments
- Provide the course outline and class calendar that will include a description of any special projects or assignments
- Arrange to meet with individual students before and after class as required

As a student, it is your responsibility to**:**

- Attend class in person and/or online
- Participate actively by reviewing course material, interacting with classmates, and responding promptly in your communication with me
- Read and comprehend the textbook
- Complete the required assignments and exams
- Ask for help when there is a question or problem
- Keep copies of all paperwork, including this syllabus, handouts, and all assignments
- Be aware of and comply with academic honesty policies in the HCCS Student Handbook

Assignments, Exams, and Activities

Written Assignment

Additional information on the term paper will be made available after students complete a paper preparation exercise. The paper preparation exercise will allow students to practice evaluating the quality of writing and argument that will be required for their own term papers to be successful.

Please note that all papers will be run through Turnitin.com's plagiarism detector.

Term Paper – 3-5 Pages on Chosen Topic, MLA Style

Quizzes

All quizzes will be given using Eagle Online, HCC's learning management system. The quizzes are due by the date listed on the course schedule, but they may be completed early if students wish. If you have any questions about how to access the quizzes, please ask!

Quiz #1 – Socrates and Plato
Quiz #2 – Descartes' Meditations
Quiz #3 – Hume's Enquiry Concerning Human Understanding
Quiz #4 – Hegel's Philosophy of History
Quiz #5 – Marx and Engels' Communist Manifesto
Quiz #6 – Sartre's Existentialism Is a Humanism

Discussions

All discussions will consist of written posts to a course forum on Eagle Online, HCC's learning management system. Discussions will follow this format:

1. Students make an original post on the current philosopher and his work (there will be a question prompt for you to answer).
2. Students respond to at least two other students by questioning, explaining, analyzing, evaluating, or expanding upon their postings.
3. Students receive credit for the assignment by making the original post as well as two responses to other students. Partial credit will not be given.
4. **Plagiarism will not be tolerated on discussion posts.** If you do not use your own words, you will be caught and receive a zero for the assignment. Repeated violations of academic dishonesty will result in a zero for the course and a report to HCC administration.

If you have any questions about how to access the course forum, please ask!

Discussion #1 – The Socratic Method
Discussion #2 – Descartes' Meditations
Discussion #3 – Hume's Enquiry Concerning Human Understanding
Discussion #4 – Hegel's Philosophy of History
Discussion #5 – Marx and Engels' Communist Manifesto
Discussion #6 – Sartre's Existentialism Is a Humanism

Course Activities

There are several course activities that must be completed during the semester. These assignments will generally be graded based on successful completion of the assignment. The exception to this rule is the syllabus quiz, which students will need to pass with 100% in order to move on to the first unit of the course. The paper preparation exercise introduces students to the scoring rubric for the term paper.

Introduction: Lights, Camera, Action
Course Scavenger Hunt
Syllabus Quiz
Paper Preparation Exercise

Final Exam

Final Exam – 6 Written Questions, 1 Per Philosopher Studied

Grading Formula

Your grade is based on a weighted average of assignments. The weight and type of each assignment is as follows:

Discussions/Activities = 20%
Quizzes = 20%
Term Paper = 30%
Final Exam = 30%

Incomplete Policy:
Incompletes will only be given in extraordinary circumstances. Students who continually miss previously extended deadlines will not be given incompletes.

HCC Grading Scale can be found on this site under Academic Information:
http://www.hccs.edu/resources-for/current-students/student-handbook/

Course Calendar

Jun 10	Introduction: Lights, Camera, Action!	Due by 11:59pm
	Course Scavenger Hunt	Due by 11:59pm
	Syllabus Quiz	Due by 11:59pm
Jun 13	Discussion #1: The Socratic Method	Due by 11:59pm
	Quiz #1: Socrates & Plato	Due by 11:59pm
Jun 16	Discussion #2: Descartes' Meditations	Due by 11:59pm
	Quiz #2: Descartes' Meditations	Due by 11:59pm
Jun 18	Paper Preparation Exercise	Due by 11:59pm
Jun 21	Discussion #3: Hume's Enquiry	Due by 11:59pm
	Quiz #3: Hume's Enquiry	Due by 11:59pm
Jun 25	Discussion #4: Hegel's Philosophy of History	Due by 11:59pm
	Quiz #4: Hegel's Philosophy of History	Due by 11:59pm
Jun 29	Discussion #5: Marx and Engel's Manifesto	Due by 11:59pm
	Quiz #5: Marx and Engel's Manifesto	Due by 11:59pm
Jul 2	Term Paper	Due by 11:59pm
Jul 5	Discussion #6: Sartre's Existentialism	Due by 11:59pm
	Quiz #6: Sartre's Existentialism	Due by 11:59pm
Jul 9	Final Exam	Due by 11:59pm

Syllabus Modifications

The instructor reserves the right to modify the syllabus at any time during the semester and will promptly notify students in writing, typically by e-mail, of any such changes.

Instructor's Practices and Procedures

Missed Assignments

Late work will be accepted on a case-by-case basis. If you know you will be late on an assignment, it is always better to let your instructor know in advance so that arrangements can be made for making up late assignments. Late work will not be accepted after the last day of class, no exceptions!

Academic Integrity

Academic dishonesty will not be tolerated. A student who is academically dishonest is claiming an advantage not available to other students. The instructor is responsible for measuring each student's individual achievements and also for ensuring that all students compete on a level playing field. Thus, in our system, the instructor has teaching, grading, and enforcing roles. You are expected to be familiar with HCC's policy on Academic Dishonesty located here.

Pleading ignorance of the rules, including improper documentation (MLA, APA, etc.) is no justification for academic dishonesty.

Students who plagiarize, collude, or cheat will not have an opportunity to resubmit their work and they will receive a grade of 0 for the first assignment, an F in the course for a second assignment, and a report in our Maxient system which could lead to dismissal from the college.

Attendance Procedures

Students are expected to login daily to check announcements. Time spent online should be equal to that of regular class attendance (three hours per week), not including time spent studying material. A student who does not complete any assignments before Sept 3, 2019 will be dropped from the course, no exceptions.

Student Conduct

In an online course, netiquette is paramount. See the Start Here! Module in our Canvas course shell for more information about netiquette and how you can be respectful of your fellow students during online interactions.

HCC Policies

Here's the link to the HCC Student Handbook http://www.hccs.edu/resources-for/current-students/student-handbook/ In it you will find information about the following:

- Academic Information
- Academic Support
- Attendance, Repeating Courses, and Withdrawal
- Career Planning and Job Search
- Childcare
- disAbility Support Services
- Electronic Devices
- Equal Educational Opportunity
- Financial Aid TV (FATV)
- General Student Complaints
- Grade of FX
- Incomplete Grades
- International Student Services
- Health Awareness
- Libraries/Bookstore
- Police Services & Campus Safety
- Student Life at HCC
- Student Rights and Responsibilities
- Student Services
- Testing
- Transfer Planning
- Veteran Services

EGLS^3

The EGLS^3 (Evaluation for Greater Learning Student Survey System) will be available for most courses near the end of the term until finals start. This brief survey will give invaluable information to your faculty about their teaching. Results are anonymous and will be available to faculty and division chairs after the end of the term. EGLS^3 surveys are only available for the Fall and Spring semesters. EGLS3 surveys are not offered during the Summer semester due to logistical constraints.
http://www.hccs.edu/resources-for/current-students/egls3-evaluate-your-professors/

Campus Carry Link

Here's the link to the HCC information about Campus Carry:
http://www.hccs.edu/departments/police/campus-carry/

HCC Email Policy

When communicating via email, HCC requires students to communicate only through the HCC email system to protect your privacy. If you have not activated your HCC student email account, you can go to HCC Eagle ID and activate it now. You may also use Canvas Inbox to communicate.

Housing and Food Assistance for Students

Any student who faces challenges securing their foods or housing and believes this may affect their performance in the course is urged to contact the Dean of Students at their college for support. Furthermore, please notify the professor if you are comfortable in doing so.

This will enable HCC to provide any resources that HCC may possess.

Office of Institutional Equity

Use the link below to access the HCC Office of Institutional Equity, Inclusion, and Engagement (http://www.hccs.edu/departments/institutional-equity/)

disAbility Services

HCC strives to make all learning experiences as accessible as possible. If you anticipate or experience academic barriers based on your disability (including long and short term conditions, mental health, chronic or temporary medical conditions), please meet with a campus Abilities Counselor as soon as possible in order to establish reasonable accommodations. Reasonable accommodations are established through an interactive process between you, your instructor(s) and Ability Services. It is the policy and practice of HCC to create inclusive and accessible learning environments consistent with federal and state law. For more information, please go to https://www.hccs.edu/programs/catalog/disability-support-services/

Title IX

Houston Community College is committed to cultivating an environment free from inappropriate conduct of a sexual or gender-based nature including sex discrimination, sexual assault, sexual harassment, and sexual violence. Sex discrimination includes all forms of sexual and gender-based misconduct and violates an individual's fundamental rights and personal dignity. Title IX prohibits discrimination on the basis of sex-including pregnancy and parental status in educational programs and activities. If you require an accommodation due to pregnancy please contact an Abilities Services Counselor. The Director of EEO/Compliance is designated as the Title IX Coordinator and Section 504 Coordinator. All inquiries concerning HCC policies, compliance with applicable laws, statutes, and regulations (such as Title VI, Title IX, and Section 504), and complaints may be directed to:

David Cross
Director EEO/Compliance
Office of Institutional Equity & Diversity
3100 Main
(713) 718-8271
Houston, TX 77266-7517 or Institutional.Equity@hccs.edu
http://www.hccs.edu/departments/institutional-equity/title-ix-know-your-rights/

Office of the Dean of Students

Contact the office of the Dean of Students to seek assistance in determining the correct complaint procedure to follow or to identify the appropriate academic dean or supervisor for informal resolution of complaints.

https://www.hccs.edu/about-hcc/procedures/student-rights-policies--procedures/student-complaints/speak-with-the-dean-of-students/

Department Chair Contact Information

Helen Graham, Ed.D.
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555 Community College Dr.
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http://learning.hccs.edu/faculty/helen.graham